KnowledgeDesk — Offline Help with Cloud AI & Local LLM — Installation Guide

TurboCASH / osFinancials KnowledgeDesk — Offline Help with Cloud AI & Local LLM • **Version 1.2** • *Setup, First Launch, and Optional Configuration*

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1. System Requirements

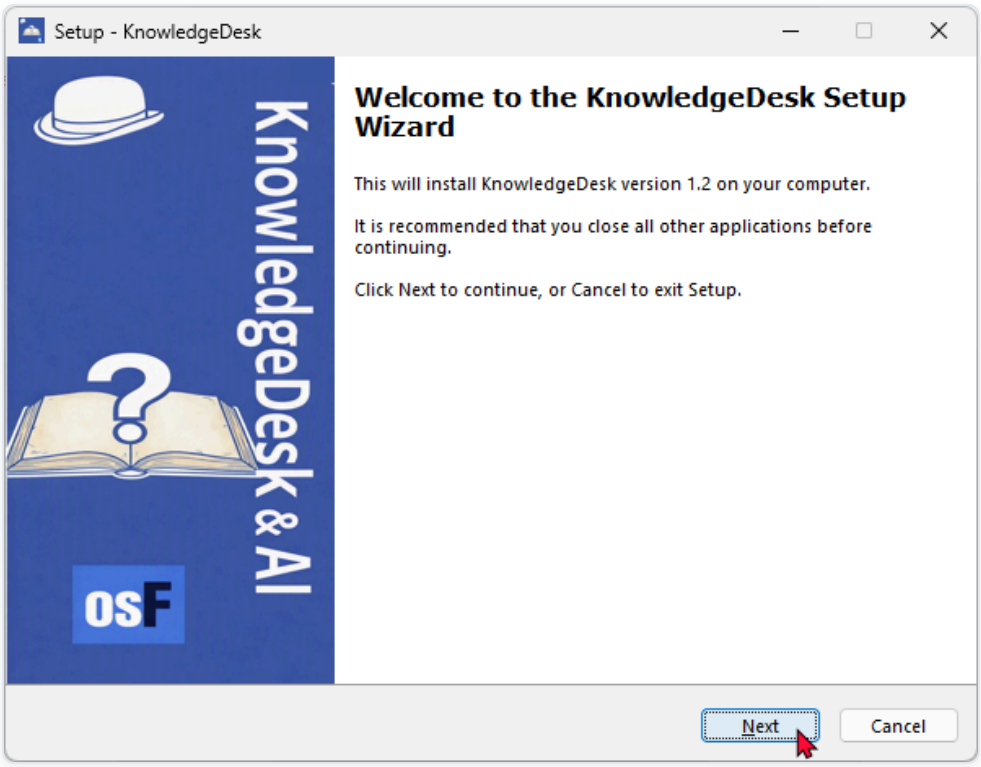
COMPONENT	REQUIREMENT
Operating System	Windows 10 or Windows 11 (32-bit or 64-bit)
Browser	Edge, Chrome, Firefox, or Brave (any modern browser)
Disk space	~50 MB for the app + documentation
Optional (Local LLM)	Ollama installed, 8 GB RAM recommended, 10 GB free disk for models

> 💡 **No internet required for the core app.** The help documentation, search, and reader tools all work offline. Internet is only needed if you choose to use cloud AI providers.

2. Installing KnowledgeDesk

2.1 — Run the installer

Double-click `KnowledgeDesk-Setup-1.2.0.exe`. If Windows shows a SmartScreen warning (because the installer is new), click **More info** → **Run anyway**.

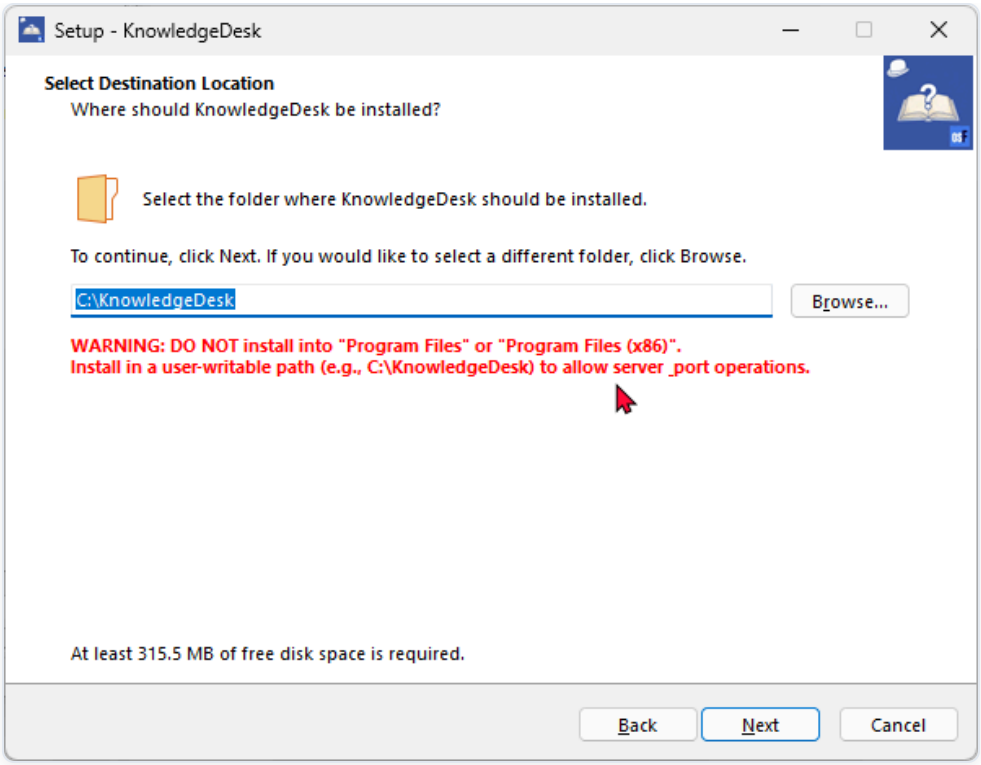


Installer welcome page

2.2 — Accept the license

Read the license agreement and click **I accept the agreement** to continue.

2.3 — Choose an install location



Choose a user-writable folder — NOT Program Files

The default is `C:\KnowledgeDesk`. We strongly recommend keeping this.

> ⚠️ **Do NOT install into "Program Files" or "Program Files (x86)".** Windows restricts write access to these folders via UAC, which prevents the app from binding to a local port and saving configuration. Always use a user-writable path.

If you try to install into Program Files, the installer will show an error and let you pick a different folder.

2.4 — Desktop shortcut (optional)

Check **Create a desktop icon** if you want quick access from the desktop. A Start Menu shortcut is created automatically regardless.

When enabled, the installer places a shortcut on your desktop with the KnowledgeDesk icon and name:



The desktop shortcut after installation

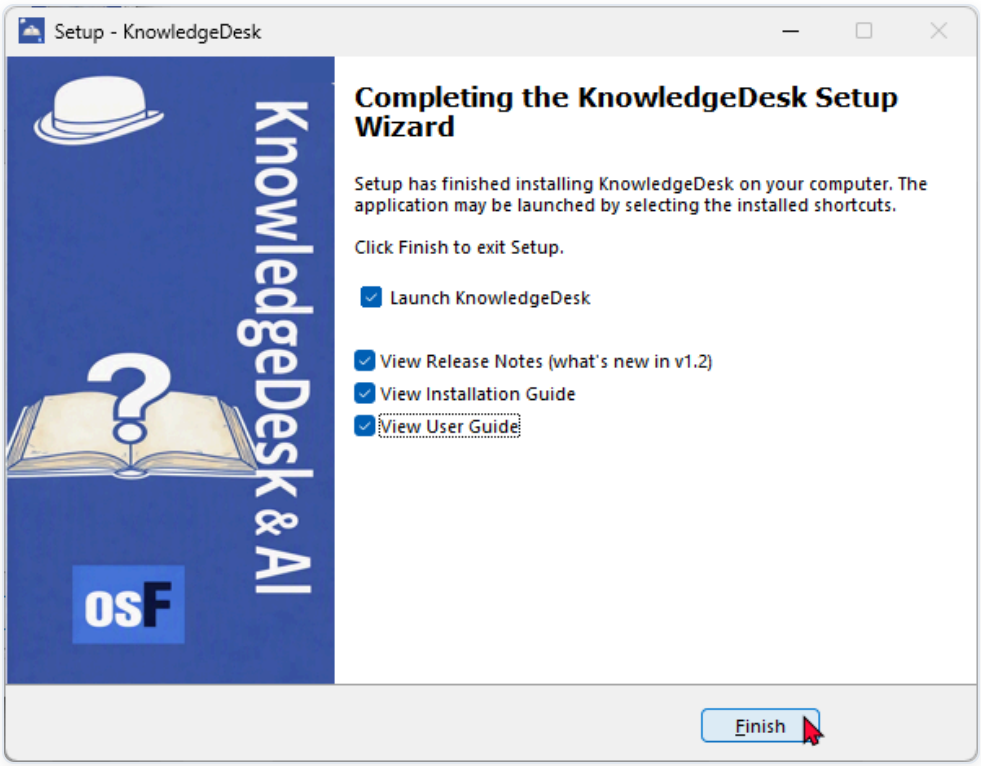
> 💡 **Two shortcuts, two locations:** the desktop shortcut is optional; the Start Menu shortcut (under *KnowledgeDesk*) is always created. Both launch the same application.

2.5 — Complete the install

Click **Install**. The wizard copies the application and its complete offline Help System (about 315 MB) and finishes in a few seconds. The Help System is bundled locally so every guide, topic, and search result works without an internet connection.

2.6 — The Finish page

When installation completes, you'll see the **Completing the KnowledgeDesk Setup Wizard** page. It offers four options:



The Finish page — check any combination of the four options

OPTION	WHAT IT OPENS	DEFAULT
☑ **Launch KnowledgeDesk**	The app itself in your default browser	Checked
☐ **View Release Notes**	What's new in this version	Unchecked
☐ **View User Guide**	Interface tour and feature reference (the companion to this guide)	Unchecked
☐ **View Installation Guide**	This document — installation walkthrough and first-launch steps	Unchecked

You can check any combination — all four will open in separate browser tabs. Click **Finish** to close the installer.

> ✅ **Recommended first launch:** leave all four checked. You'll get the app, the user guide, this installation guide, and the release notes open side-by-side — all the documentation you need to get started.

3. First Launch

3.1 — What opens after clicking Finish

Depending on which options you checked on the Finish page (Section 2.6), one or more browser tabs will open:

- The app at `http://127.0.0.1:39820`
- The User Guide (if checked)
- This Installation Guide (if checked)
- The Release Notes (if checked)

All four can be left checked and will open in separate browser tabs.

3.2 — What happens on launch

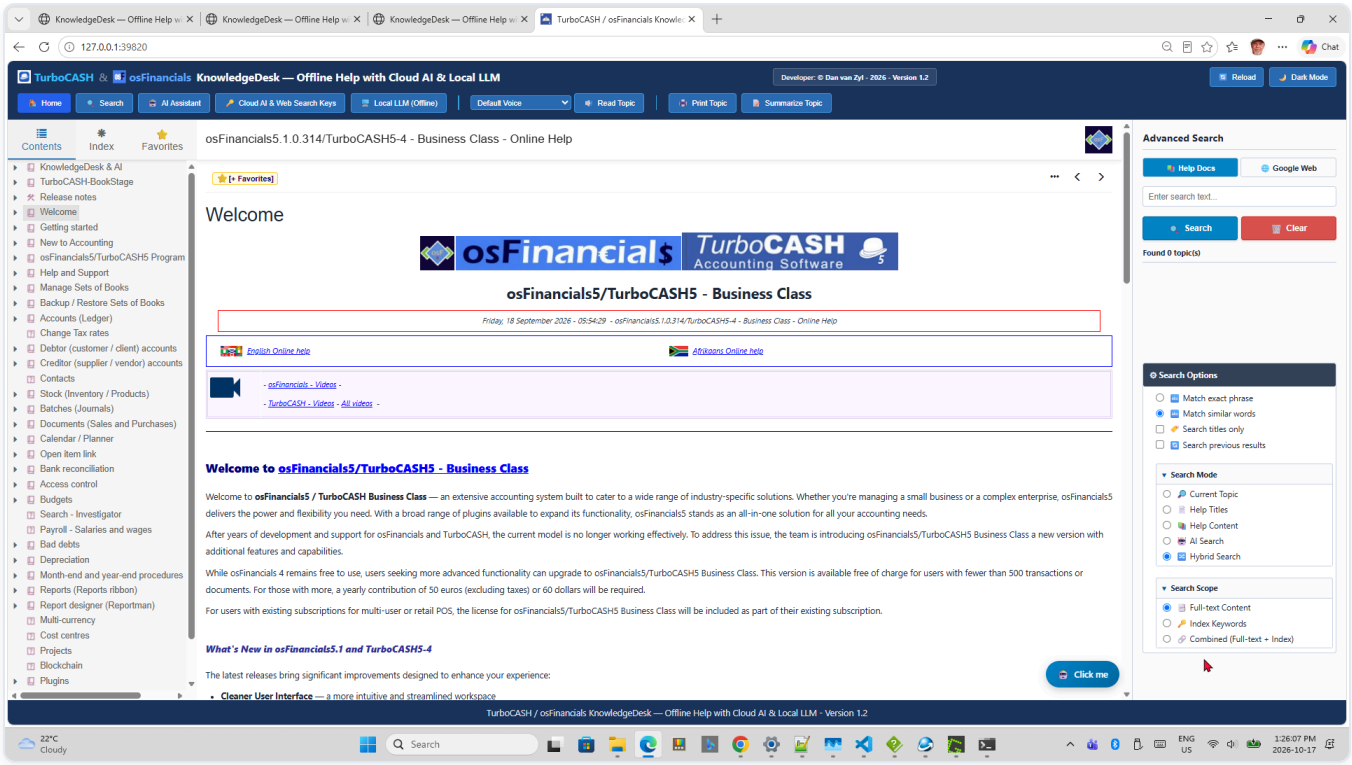
When you click **Finish**, the installer closes and launches the KnowledgeDesk server.

> 🔧 **The server runs minimized.** The Go server runs in a Windows Terminal/Command Prompt window that is **minimized in your taskbar**. It will look like this if you click on it:

4. The Main Interface

When you first launch KnowledgeDesk (or refresh the browser), you will briefly see a **Splash Screen** with a loading spinner and the TurboCASH / osFinancials branding.

This is the app connecting to your browser's Local Storage to load your saved API keys, Favorites, and theme preferences. It only takes a moment, and the screen will automatically fade away once your workspace is ready.



The main KnowledgeDesk interface at first launch

The application window is divided into five distinct areas to help you find what you need quickly:

1. **Header Bar (Top)**
   Displays the app branding, version number (v1.2), and global controls:
   - **Branding Links:** The **TurboCASH** and **osFinancials** text logos are clickable. Clicking either one will open their respective official website in a new browser tab.
   - 🔄 **Reload:** Reloads the entire KnowledgeDesk application. This refreshes the Contents and Index (table of contents) and returns you to the Welcome topic.
   - 🌙 **Dark Mode / ☀️ Light Mode:** Toggles the interface theme.
2. **Navigation Bar (Below Header)**
   Your main toolbox. From left to right:
   - 🏠 **Home:** Returns to the Welcome screen.
   - 🔍 **Search:** Opens the Advanced Search panel.
   - 🤖 **AI Assistant:** Opens the chat interface.
   - 🔑 **Cloud AI & Web Search Keys:** Where you configure your API keys.
   - 🖥️ **Local LLM (Offline):** Settings for local offline AI.
   - **Default Voice:** Choose a voice for the text-to-speech reader.
   - 🔊 **Read Topic:** Reads the current help page aloud.
   - 🖨️ **Print Topic:** Prints the page or saves it as a PDF.
   - 📝 **Summarize Topic:** Generates a summary of the currently selected topic. By default, it creates an offline summary from the local help content. If you have saved an API key or enabled a Local LLM, it will automatically upgrade to an AI-generated summary.

3. **Left Pane (Navigation)**
   Browse the manual using three tabs:
   - 📚 **Contents:** A tree view of all help chapters.
   - 🗂️ **Index:** An alphabetical list of keywords.
   - ⭐ **Favorites:** Your bookmarked pages.
4. **Center Pane (Reading Area)**
   The main workspace where the help documentation is displayed. Links inside topics will open right here.
5. **Right Pane (Contextual Panel)**
   This area changes based on what you click in the Navigation Bar. By default, it shows the **Advanced Search** panel. You can also use the tabs at the top of this pane to switch between **Help Docs** and **Google Web** search.

> 💡 **The "Click Me" Button:** You will notice a floating blue **Click me** button in the bottom-right corner of the screen. This is a quick shortcut to open the AI Assistant or perform a web search without using the main navigation bar.

The interface is divided into four main areas:

4.1 — Header Bar

The top of the window shows:

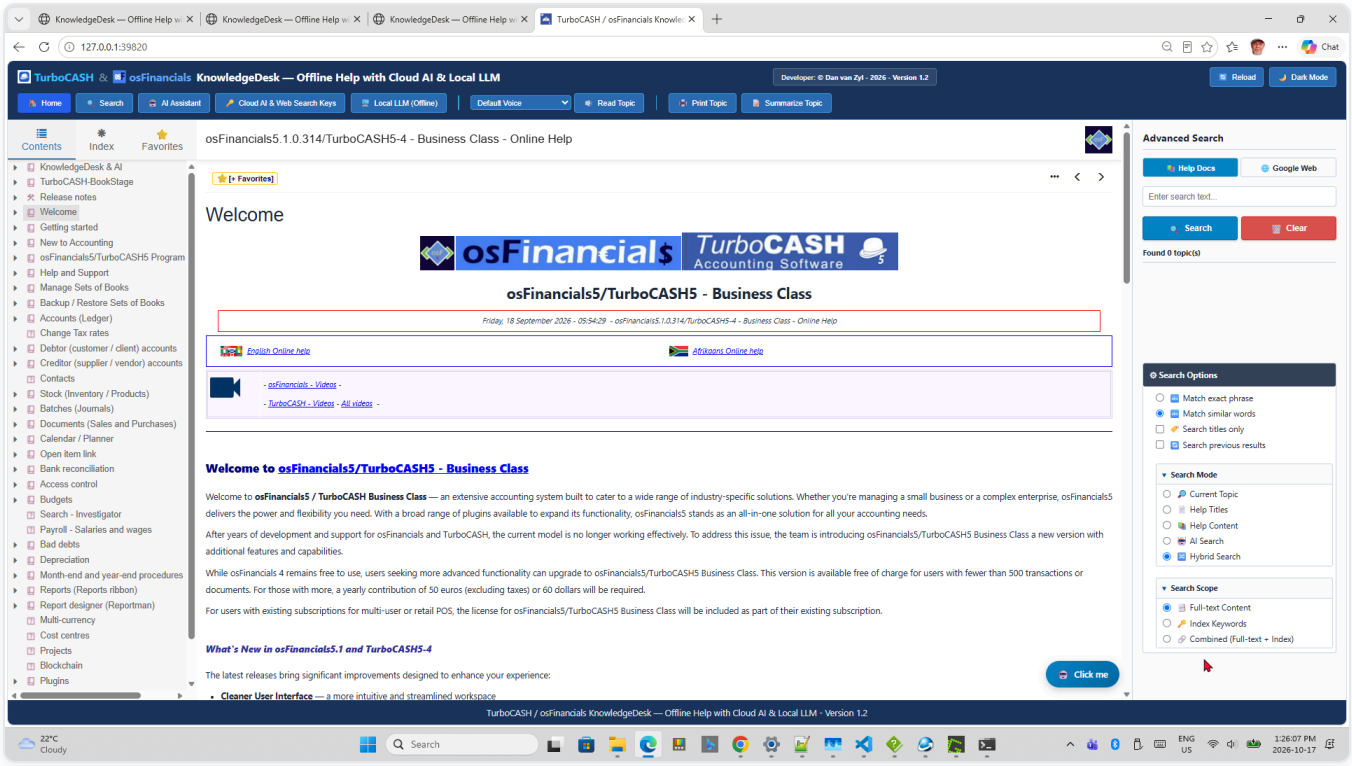
- **Branding** — TurboCASH, osFinancials, and the KnowledgeDesk subtitle
- **Developer info** — version number (v1.2)
- 🔄 **Reload:** Reloads the application, refreshes the Contents (table of contents), and returns to the default Welcome topic.
- 🌙 **Dark Mode** / 🌞 **Light Mode** — toggle the theme.

4.2 — Navigation Bar

The button row below the header gives quick access to:

BUTTON	OPENS
🏠 Home	The Welcome help topic
🔍 Search	Advanced search panel
🤖 AI Assistant	Chat with the AI
🔑 Cloud AI & Web Search Keys	API key configuration
🖥️ Local LLM (Offline)	Offline AI settings + toggle
🔊 Read Topic	Text-to-speech (with Pause / Resume / Stop)
🖨️ Print Topic	Print or export the current topic as PDF
📝 Summarize Page	AI-generated summary of the current topic

4.3 — Left Pane (Navigation)



Left pane with tabs for Contents, Index, Search, and Favorites

The left pane offers several tabs for finding content:

- 📚 **Contents** — tree view of all help topics, organized by chapter
- 🗂️ **Index** — alphabetical keyword index.

- ⭐ **Favorites** — your bookmarked topics.

> 💡 **About the Search tab.** The embedded help system originally shipped with a Search tab in the left pane. KnowledgeDesk replaces it with ⭐ **Favorites**, because the app provides its own Advanced Search in the right pane (opened by the 🔍 **Search** navigation button). This avoids two competing search boxes and gives bookmarks a natural home next to Contents and Index.

4.4 — Center Pane (Help System)

The main content area displays the currently selected help topic. Links inside topics navigate to related sections, and external links open in a new browser tab.

TOPIC NAVIGATION CONTROLS

In the top-right corner of the reading pane, you will see a small row of navigation icons. These allow you to navigate the manual sequentially without using the left-hand Contents tree:

- **...** (Ellipses): Opens a dropdown menu showing all the headings (H1-H4) inside the current topic, allowing you to jump directly to a specific section.
- **^** (Up Arrow): Moves you back to the main parent topic (chapter) in the Contents tree. This is useful when you are reading a sub-topic and want to quickly return to the main chapter overview.
- **<** (Left Arrow): Moves to the **previous** topic in the manual.
- **>** (Right Arrow): Moves to the **next** topic in the manual.

4.5 — Right Pane (Contextual Panel)

This area changes based on what you click in the Navigation Bar. By default, it shows the **Advanced Search** panel. You can also use the tabs at the top of this pane to switch between **Help Docs** and **Google Web** search.

PANEL	PURPOSE
🔍 **Advanced Search**	Full help search with filters, AI Search, and Web Search options.
🤖 **AI Assistant**	The chat interface to ask questions about the documentation.
🔑 **Cloud AI & Web Search Keys**	Configure API keys for Groq, Gemini, OpenAI, etc.
🖥️ **Local LLM (Offline)**	Configure and enable offline AI using Ollama.

> 💡 **Tips for the Right Pane & Navigation:**
>
> - 🏠 **Home Button:** Clicking this in the top navigation bar will return you to the **Welcome** page in the Contents tab.
> - **Resizing:** You can resize the right pane by dragging the vertical bar that separates it from the center reading pane.
> - 💬 **Click Me Button:** You will notice a floating blue **Click me** button in the bottom-right corner of the screen. This is a quick shortcut to open the AI Assistant or perform a web search without using the main navigation bar.

> 🛑 **How to close KnowledgeDesk:** Because KnowledgeDesk serves the help files from your own computer, the server must stay running while you use the app.
>
> It runs minimized in your Windows taskbar. When you are finished, you can simply close your browser tabs. If you want to completely shut down the background server, **click the minimized terminal window in your taskbar and click the X** to close it. The browser will then show a `127.0.0.1 refused to connect` message, which confirms the server has been successfully stopped.

5. Optional — Configure Cloud AI Keys

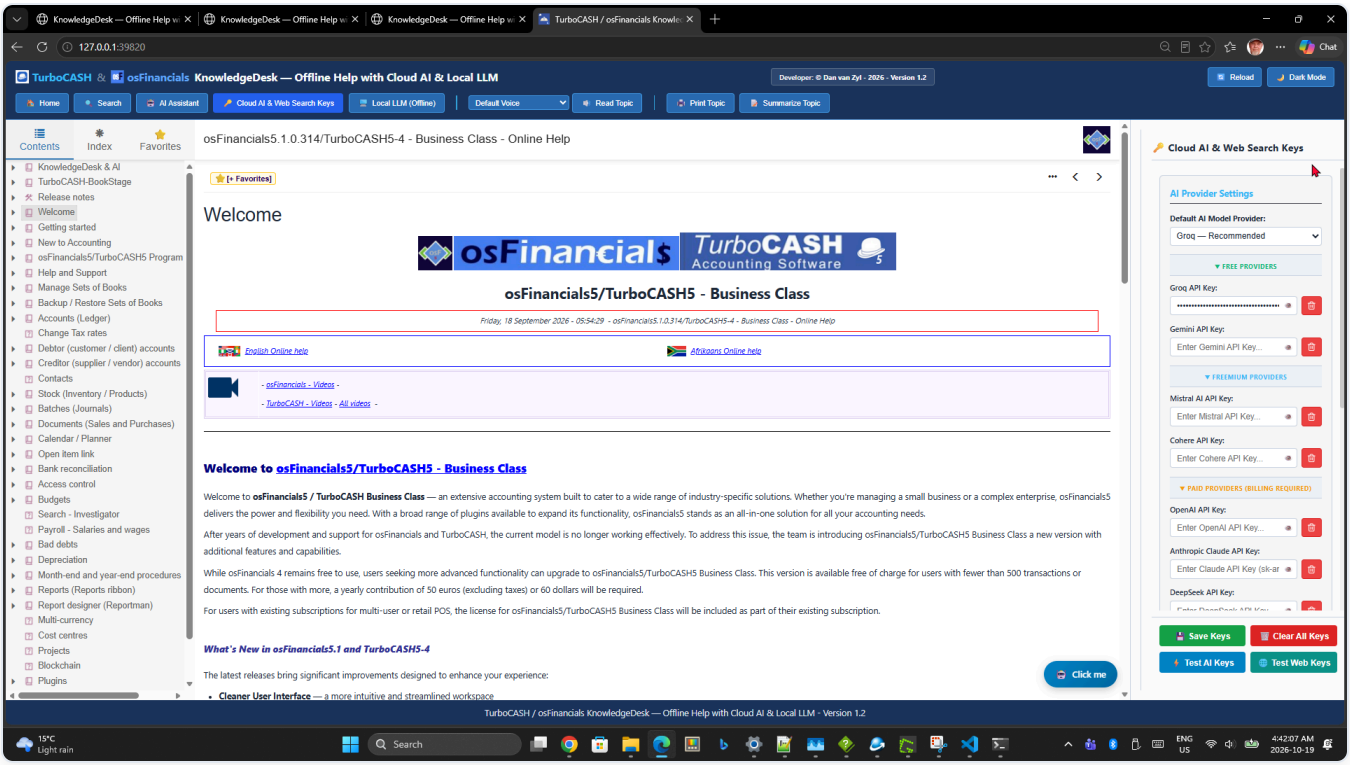
Cloud AI is **optional**. If you want to use a cloud provider (Groq, Gemini, OpenAI, Claude, etc.), you need an API key. The fastest path is **Groq**, which has a generous free tier — no credit card required — and is the default provider in KnowledgeDesk.

5.1 — Get a free Groq or Gemini key

We recommend starting with **Groq** (the default provider) or **Google Gemini**. Both offer a free tier with no credit card required.

1. **Groq:** Visit console.groq.com/keys
2. **Gemini:** Visit aistudio.google.com/app/apikey
3. Sign in with an account and click **Create API key**
4. Copy the key — it starts with `gsk_...` (for Groq) or `AIza...` (for Gemini)

5.2 — Enter the key



Paste the key into the matching provider field, then click Save Keys

1. In the app, click 🔑 **Cloud AI & Web Search Keys** in the navigation bar
2. Paste the key into the correct field (e.g., **Groq API Key** or **Gemini API Key**)
3. Click 💾 **Save Keys**
4. Reload the app — the key is now active

5.3 — Using a different provider

The Cloud AI panel supports 8 AI providers plus 2 web search services, grouped by tier:

TIER	PROVIDERS
▼ **Free**	Groq, Google Gemini
▼ **Freemium**	Mistral AI, Cohere
▼ **Paid**	OpenAI, Anthropic Claude, DeepSeek, OpenRouter
🌐 **Web Search**	Bing API Key
📌 **Public Configuration**	Google CSE ID (ships preconfigured)

For the full provider matrix — including sign-up links, cost tiers, and screenshots of each field — see **Section 7 (Cloud AI Configuration)** in the User Guide.

> 💡 **Only one key is needed to start. Groq** is the default and recommended first choice due to its fast inference speeds. You can add more providers (like Gemini) later at any time. The default model selector at the top of the panel controls which provider is used when multiple keys are saved.

6. Optional — Set Up Local LLM (Offline AI)

For a fully private, offline AI experience — no API keys, no internet — you can run a local model on your own machine.

6.1 — Install Ollama

1. Download from ollama.com/download
2. Run the installer
3. Ollama starts automatically and appears in your system tray

6.2 — Pull a model

Open PowerShell and run:

```
ollama pull llama3.2:3b
```

This downloads ~2 GB. Wait for "success" before continuing.

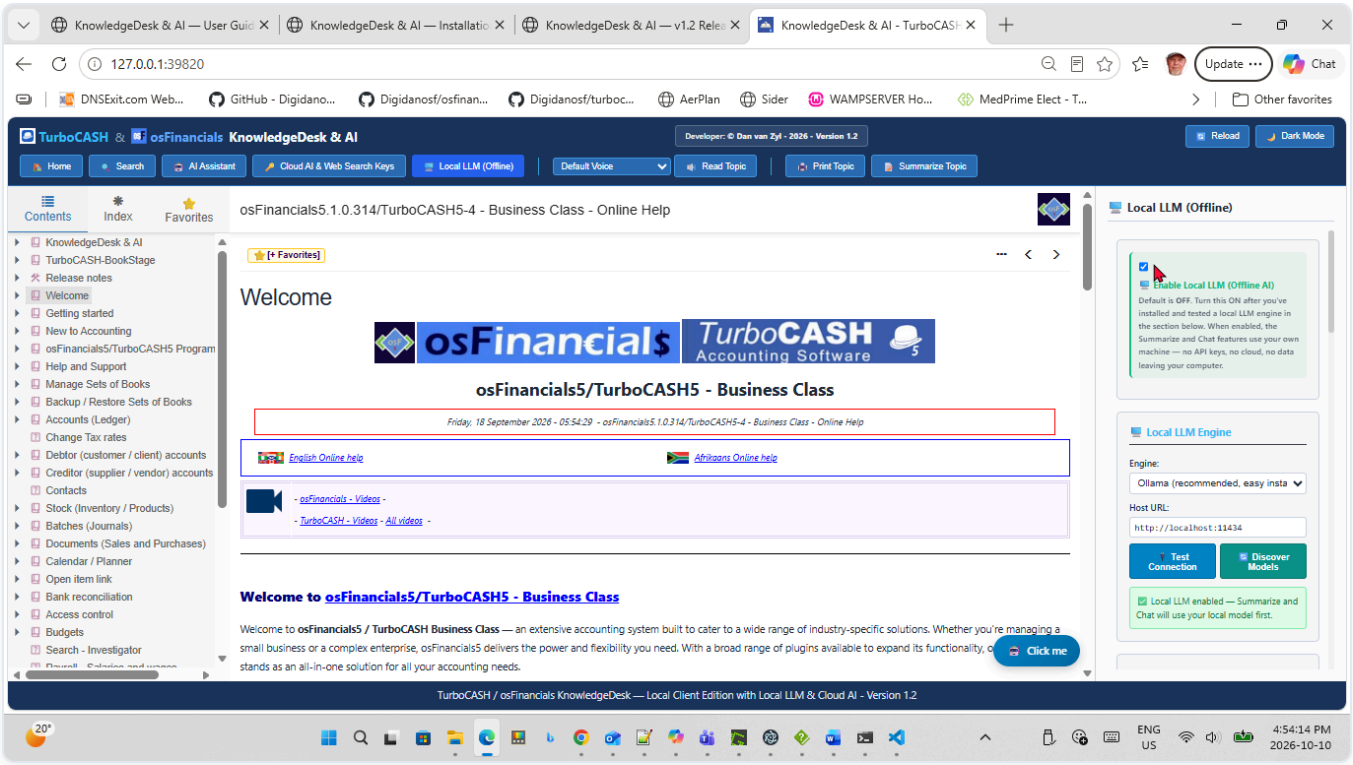
6.3 — Set the CORS environment variable

Ollama blocks browser requests by default. To allow KnowledgeDesk to reach it:

1. Press `Win` + `R` → type `sysdm.cpl` → Enter
2. Go to **Advanced** → **Environment Variables**
3. Under **User variables**, click **New**
4. Variable name: `OLLAMA_ORIGINS`
5. Variable value: `http://127.0.0.1:39820`
6. Click OK on all dialogs
7. **Restart Ollama** — quit it from the tray, then relaunch

> ⚠️ **Restart is required.** Ollama only reads `OLLAMA_ORIGINS` at startup. If you don't restart it, the setting won't take effect.

6.4 — Enable the toggle in KnowledgeDesk



Enable Local LLM after discovering your models

1. In the app, click 🖥️ **Local LLM (Offline)**
2. Click 🔄 **Discover Models** — should show your installed models
3. Select a model — `llama3.2:3b` recommended
4. **Turn ON** the "Enable Local LLM (Offline AI)" toggle

7. Verifying the Installation

Everything is working if:

- The app loads in your browser at `http://127.0.0.1:39820`
- The left pane shows the help topic tree
- Clicking a topic loads it in the center pane
- The browser console (F12) shows no errors

Quick test

1. Press `F12` to open Developer Tools
2. Click the **Console** tab
3. You should see a line starting with `[Vault] Origin: http://127.0.0.1:39820`
4. If any lines start with `[Vault]` and are followed by `UNAVAILABLE`, storage is blocked — try disabling private/incognito mode

8. Uninstalling

Three options to uninstall:

1. **Settings → Apps → KnowledgeDesk → Uninstall**
2. **Control Panel → Programs and Features → KnowledgeDesk → Uninstall**
3. Run `C:\KnowledgeDesk\unins000.exe` directly

> 💾 **About your settings:** Uninstalling removes the app files but leaves your browser-stored API keys in place. If you reinstall later, your keys will still be there.

9. Getting Help

If you encounter any issues during installation, please email:

> 📧 **Contact:** osfinancials1@gmail.com

Include your Windows version and any error messages you saw.

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